



Introduction to Review Writing Teaching Ideas

Learning Objective: To understand the features of review writing.

Success Criteria:

- To identify features of review writing in an example.
- To define success criteria for review writing.
- To share successful examples of review writing.

Context

- This is an introductory or revision session designed to encourage students to identify the features of review writing in a group task.

Resources

Sticky notes

A3/poster paper – 1 per group

Individual whiteboards

Starter

Mind-Mapping

Students should begin by individually mind-mapping anything they know about review writing at the start of the lesson. This may be quite limited – don't worry because by the end of the lesson they will have a full review writing checklist to use in future lessons.

Main Activities

Success Criteria Carousel

In groups of three/four, students should look at a carousel of reviews and identify the main features of reviews. Three different reviews have been provided to use and more reviews can be sourced for different films depending on the interests and numbers of the students.

Students should read the reviews and identify success criteria for the following:

- the layout of the review;
- the vocabulary that is used;
- the way the review is structured;
- any techniques that are being used.

These should be recorded on A3 or poster paper by each group so that definitive success criteria are agreed upon by the group.

Plenary

Feedback

As a class, the reviews should be discussed and the success criteria shared from each group with reference to the different reviews that have been analysed during the carousel. A class list can be recorded at the front of the class. Where students have not identified some of the criteria, questioning by the teacher should guide them to any areas they have missed.

Success criteria features could be shared at this point using a feedback ball, where it is passed to different students for them to share the features they have identified. It could also be done by sending one person from each group to carousel round the other groups and share their findings.

Students should record the new criteria on their mind maps from the starter, ideally in a different coloured pen to show their new learning in the lesson.



Moving On

True or False

Each student should be given a sticky note. On their sticky note, they should write a statement that is either true or false about review writing that they have found out in the lesson that day.

Students should be chosen at random to read out their statement. The rest of the class should hold up an individual whiteboard to show whether they think the statement is true or false.

